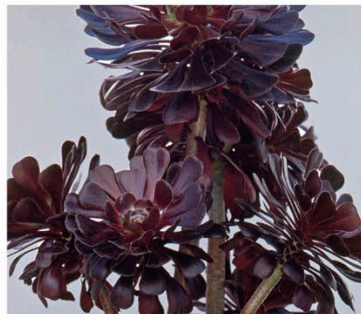


Leaves for containers

Foliage is an essential ingredient of a well-balanced container display. Use leaves as foils for flowers and to add shape and form to a design.

Ferns, coral bells, and ivy leaves add rich texture to a fall or winter display of violas, while bronze sedges set against dwarf daffodils will liven up a spring pot. To create a tropical look in summer, pair dark-leaved coleus or the broody blackie sweet potato vine with scarlet and cerise dahlias, verbenas, and salvias. Some leafy plants need no flowery partners to make a statement. Striped and spiked agave is best planted solo; a single large-leaved hosta will produce a beautiful display of color and form; and Japanese fatsia's handsome glossy foliage sets off a glazed pot to perfection.



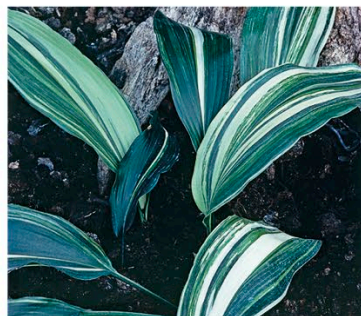
PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Aeonium 'Zwartkop'

PURPLE CREST AEONIUM This tender evergreen succulent has upright stems, clothed with glossy purple-black leaves. Grow it in containers of well-drained all-purpose potting soil in a sunny, sheltered site. Overwinter under cover.

↑24in (60cm) ↔3ft (1m)

☀ Z9-11



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Aspidistra elatior

CAST-IRON PLANT This slow-growing evergreen perennial has upright, glossy dark green leaves, and looks attractive in a large container. Plant in a sheltered site, away from cold winds. 'Variegata' (above) has cream-striped leaves.

↑24in (60cm) ↔18in (45cm)

☀ Z7-10



PERENNIAL SMALL

Athyrium niponicum var. *pictum*

JAPANESE PAINTED FERN This small deciduous fern has deeply divided gray-green leaves with metallic purple and silver highlights. Grow in a large container. Water well in summer.

↑12in (30cm) ↔indefinite

☀ Z4-8



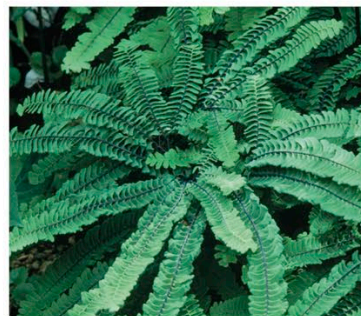
PERENNIAL SMALL

Acorus gramineus

GRASSY-LEAVED SWEET FLAG This semievergreen perennial is grown for its grassy arching foliage. Use as a specimen or in a mixed display in permanently wet soil-based potting mix. 'Ogon' (above) has creamy yellow-striped foliage.

↑10in (25cm) ↔6in (15cm)

☀ Z5-9



PERENNIAL SMALL

Adiantum aleuticum

WESTERN MAIDENHAIR FERN Ideal for pots in shade, this semievergreen fern has small, pale green branching fronds clothed with tiny leaflets. Grow as a specimen or in a mixed display with other ferns. Water well and protect from dry winds.

↑18in (45cm)

☀ Z3-8 (N)



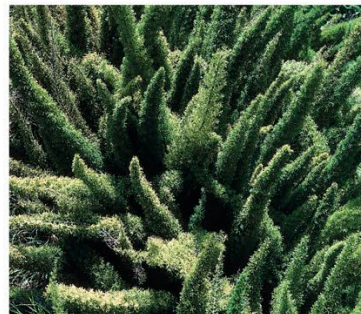
PERENNIAL LARGE

Agave americana 'Variegata'

CENTURY PLANT A tender perennial succulent grown for its fleshy, pointed, cream-edged lance-shaped leaves. Plant in a large container of all-purpose potting soil in full sun, positioned where the spines won't cause injuries. Overwinter indoors.

↑5ft (1.5m)

☀ Z9-11 (N)



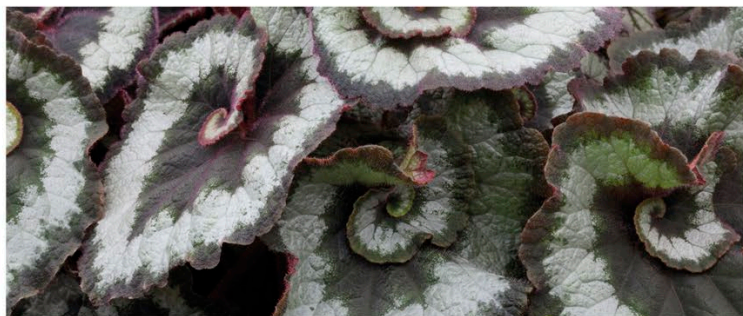
PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Asparagus densiflorus 'Myersii'

FOXTAIL FERN Grown for its fine lacy leaves, this tender perennial has a dense, plumelike appearance. Ideal for containers and windowboxes in light shade. Move it under cover for winter protection.

↑3ft (1m) ↔20in (50cm)

☀ Z10-11



PERENNIAL SMALL

Begonia 'Escargot'

BEGONIA This tender evergreen perennial is grown for its silver-edged, green-tinted purple heart-shaped leaves that have a distinctive coiled appearance. Place it outside in summer in a shady, sheltered spot, and move it under cover in winter.

↑10in (25cm) ↔20in (50cm)

☀ Z10-11